

KEYSTONE CANINE TRAINING CLUB

POLICIES AND PROCEDURES

5-12-16

ITEM	POLICY OR PROCEDURE	REV. DATE
1	SAFETY - Safety of the dogs and handlers is our first and foremost responsibility.	Orig
2	BITCHES - No bitches in season are permitted in classes.	Orig
3	CLASS SIZE - The maximum number of students in each class shall be determined by the Instructor, who shall inform the Training Director of the limit. Handlers in agility classes working multiple dogs must either pay for each dog separately, or only work one dog per sequence.	4-11-16
4	AGGRESSIVE DOGS - Aggressive dogs shall be dealt with in accordance with the "Policy for Aggressive Dogs," Appendix A.	8-06
5	POTTY AREAS - During the first class of each session, instructors should request their students to potty their dogs in the front potty area before entering the building.	1-17-14
6	DOG WASTE - All handlers are responsible for cleaning up after their dogs and disposing of it properly, as follows: put papers towels used for urine clean-up in a plastic bag and then put the plastic bag inside a trash can, and put all stool in a separate bag and throw it away outside in a covered trash can.	Orig
7	UNATTENDED DOGS - No person, member or non-member, is ever permitted to leave a dog in the building unattended.	Orig
8	CHILDREN - Children shall be at least 13 years old to work a dog and all children under 16 shall have a parent present, at all times, when working a dog. The only exceptions to this are (1) if the children are attending a specific class geared to children only, or (2) if the instructor agrees to allow a child under 13 in the class. The instructor may also evaluate the child during the first class before making a final decision on allowing the child to continue in the class.	7-17-14
9	EVALUATIONS – Evaluation forms for all basic-level or new classes should be handed out in the seventh (or last) week of class.	4-11-16

10	INSTRUCTORS' DOGS - All instructors' and assistants' dogs shall be crated or contained for any classes that the instructor/assistant is teaching/assisting in. No dog is to be tied, left in a chair, or left in a sit or down stay when the instructor/assistant is working.	4-11-16
11	INSTRUCTOR HANDBOOK - Use of the KCTC Instructor's handbook is expressly for KCTC instructors/assistants only. It is not permissible to copy it or lend it out.	4-11-16
12	NEW CLASSES - Any instructor proposing to teach any new class in a regular session is required to submit a week-by-week class syllabus to the Training Director for approval. The syllabus will be kept on file at KCTC in the event the regular instructor is unable to attend and the substitute instructor needs to know where the class is in their course.	4-11-16
13	WEATHER OR SNOW CANCELLATION – Each Instructor should take home a copy of the class roster with the names and phone numbers of the students. In the event of bad weather, each Instructor shall decide whether or not to hold his/her class. If class is cancelled, the Instructor shall call each student in the class, notify the call-back person and the website editor as soon as possible (but no later than one hour before the class start time), and notify the Training Director. The call-back person shall change the KCTC phone recording to state that a particular class (or classes) is/are cancelled on a given date, and the website editor shall post a cancellation notice to the website. If the call-back person cannot be contacted, the Instructor shall notify the President. During the first night of class, the Instructor shall either (1) inform the class that the Instructor will call them if class is cancelled, or (2) instruct the class to call the KCTC phone number or check the website homepage on bad-weather days to find out if class is cancelled. It is also recommended that the Instructor poll the class the first night to determine how close they live to the club, and if they are willing to drive in bad weather, to help the Instructor decide whether or not to cancel class in the event of bad weather. Another factor in the Instructor's decision should be whether their Assistant(s) are willing to drive to KCTC.	4-11-16
14	SUBSTITUTES - All instructors should consult the KCTC membership list and the CLASS SCHEDULE, in the event they need to find a substitute instructor for one of their classes. The CLASS SCHEDULE will show what discipline and at what level the person is capable of instructing (e.g., Obedience: Basic, Agility: Advanced, Rally: Intermediate, etc.), and the membership list will show phone numbers. It is up to each instructor to find a replacement if needed, and to notify the Training Director. If it becomes a problem to find anyone, call the Training Director.	4-11-16

15	STUDENT SAFETY - Instructors shall not leave a student, assistant, or any other person alone at the building, inside or outside, after a class. Instructors shall wait until everyone is in their car, has it started, and are pulling out of the lot before leaving. This is for the safety of everyone, particularly under harsh winter weather conditions when batteries may die.	Orig
16	BUILDING USAGE - The Building Usage page of the website shall list all the people who use the building during non-class hours, seminars, special events, etc., along with the lead person for such events.	7-17-14
17	COLLARS - Any dog working in any class using agility equipment must wear a flat collar or no collar, unless the handler signs a waiver agreeing to hold KCTC harmless for any injury to the dog.	4-11-16
18	APPRENTICE PROGRAM FOR INSTRUCTORS Each prospective instructor: For obedience: Must serve an apprenticeship including one seven week class under the guidance of an instructor. For other disciplines (agility, rally, tracking, etc.) the apprentice must serve an apprenticeship of one seven week class appropriate for that discipline. The apprentice must also have a title in the discipline being taught, or have approval of the training director, and must have earned a favorable evaluation from the instructors assisted during the apprenticeship period. Apprentice records shall be maintained by the Training Director, and be housed at KCTC.	4-11-16
19	CHANGES - Changes to this Policies and Procedures document require Board approval.	3-17-16
20	BOARD APPROVALS - A person wishing to propose a recommendation to the Board for approval should send an email to all Board members and should use the words "PROPOSED ITEM FOR BOARD APPROVAL" in the subject of the e-mail. That person should also specifically say in the e-mail what the item or recommendation is and include or attach any supporting documentation. Suggested wording is "I am requesting Board approval for . . ." The club President will include the request on the agenda for the next board meeting where a discussion will take place and a vote taken or more information will be requested.	4-11-16
21	BOARD BUSINESS BY EMAIL - The KCTC Board may conduct business by e-mail, in accordance with Appendix B.	4-11-16

22	DROP-INS - The class drop-in fee will be as stated on the class price list on the website. A liability waiver must be signed by all non-member drop-ins, upon arrival at each class. All drop-in fees collected are to be left at the club and are to be placed in the cash box. Anyone planning to drop-in on a class should first check to be sure the class is not at maximum capacity. If the class is not full, the instructor must be notified of the drop-in's intent. The instructor will keep the class size to the limit stated on the CLASS SCHEDULE page of the website.	4-11-16
23	PRIVATE LESSONS - Private lessons may be given on a voluntary basis by Instructors or Assistants at the club, not at the client's home or at the Instructor's or Assistant's home. The cost will be \$25 for a one hour session, payable to the club. Private lessons will be given when no other classes are in session at the club.	7-7-14
24	EMERGENCY PROCEDURES - Emergency phone numbers have been posted throughout the building. A first-aid kit is on the wall between the restrooms. An Incident Report should be filled out for any emergency or injury.	4-11-16
25	CLUB MAILING LIST - Article XI Section 3 of the Bylaws requires Board approval of the use of the club mailing list. This is clarified as follows: Board approval is not required to use the club mailing list for normal club business (such as sending the newsletter) and sending club announcements (such as information about club events). The club's mailing list (including both the street address list and the e-mail list) is considered club property. Personal messages to the membership, using either list, shall be approved by the Board. Any messages to the club membership shall be distributed by the Corresponding Secretary or his/her designated back-up.	4-11-16
26	CLUB PURCHASES – Board of Directors approval is required for any purchases over \$50, and membership approval (by simple majority vote) is required for any purchases over \$1000. Such purchases will be announced at the next general membership meeting or via the club newsletter. Exceptions include: rent, utilities, insurance, promotional advertising, postage, sales tax, concession purchases, newsletter expenses, enrollment refunds, re-saleable pet supplies, office supplies, (envelopes, printer toner, copying, diploma paper, etc.), building maintenance (bulbs, filters, cleaning supplies, paint, paper supplies, pest control, etc.), match and trial supplies (cash for change, flyers, raffle tickets, prize ribbons/rosettes, food, score sheets, judge's gifts, etc.), holiday party expenses (site rental fee, plaques), community event fee, and reimbursements to members for any of the above. A Director at Large shall be responsible for maintaining bathroom paper supplies and cleaning supplies, for keeping spray bottles full, and for keeping the water bowls clean.	4-11-16

27	LAPSED MEMBERSHIP – A person or family whose membership has lapsed but wants to rejoin the club may do so by submitting a new membership application and paying the membership dues. They must also take classes at the non-member rate and be voted upon by the membership in accordance with the following: <table> <tr> <th><i>Time since membership has lapsed</i></th><th><i>Number of paying classes that must be taken at the non-member rate</i></th><th><i>Membership vote on the application</i></th></tr> <tr> <td>0 – 1 year</td><td>None</td><td>Not required</td></tr> <tr> <td>1 – 2 years</td><td>One</td><td>Required</td></tr> <tr> <td>Greater than 2 years</td><td>Two</td><td>Required</td></tr> </table>	<i>Time since membership has lapsed</i>	<i>Number of paying classes that must be taken at the non-member rate</i>	<i>Membership vote on the application</i>	0 – 1 year	None	Not required	1 – 2 years	One	Required	Greater than 2 years	Two	Required	1/15/10
<i>Time since membership has lapsed</i>	<i>Number of paying classes that must be taken at the non-member rate</i>	<i>Membership vote on the application</i>												
0 – 1 year	None	Not required												
1 – 2 years	One	Required												
Greater than 2 years	Two	Required												
28	CLASS FEES FOR NEW APPLICANTS – An applicant who has taken two classes at the non-member rate and then submitted a membership application, may take a third class at the member rate if the class start date is prior to the date of the membership vote on the applicant.	7/17/14												
29	SIGN-IN SHEET – Any person using the building during non-class hours shall sign in and out with their name, time in, and time out. The sign-in sheet will be on or near the main entrance door. This does not apply to scheduled events	1/15/10												
30	CLASS ENROLLMENT PROCEDURE - Class enrollment will be in chronological order, in accordance with the following: After the "Class Schedule" and official start date for enrollment are sent out to the membership via email and posted to the website, people can fill out an enrollment form and send it in, or use the on-line "fillable" form. People can either mail hardcopy forms to our PO Box or place them in an envelope and put them in the cash box on the wall in the office along with payment. Alternatively, people can send an email to the Office Manager with their filled-out form as an attachment. Payments must be made by the posted due date to ensure enrollment. People can pay for more than one class with a single check (or cash). If people enroll after the class limit is reached, they will be informed that the class is waitlisted and that they are on the wait list for that class. Anyone who has not paid prior to the payment due date may be removed from the roster and replaced with someone on the wait list who has paid.	4-11-16												
31	K-9ERS – The K-9ers reserve the right to approve any new participants in their group. This includes practices as well as events. Only dogs who are CGC certified may participate in K-9er or KCTC events and demos. In addition, dogs shall be TDI certified to do any visitation with individuals when that visitation is part of a K-9er or KCTC demo or visit.	4/23/10												

32	BUILDING RENTAL – The building may be rented to outside organizations for a fee of \$25 per hour. A KCTC member must be present during the event. The member sponsoring the event is responsible for moving any equipment and cleaning up before and after the event. (Note – regularly scheduled cleaning will not be rescheduled for such events.)	3/23/11
33	REFERRALS – Any member who refers five new students to KCTC who enroll in classes will receive a Bonus Bone that can be redeemed for one free class.	1-16-12
34	FOSTER DOGS – People who house foster dogs will be charged the reduced rate of \$40 for a 6- or 7-week class. People who adopt foster dogs and keep them will be charged the regular rate.	11-10-13
35	ELIGIBILITY FOR AWARDS - To be eligible for a KCTC award, the dog and owner must meet all of the following criteria: a. The owner must be a KCTC member in good standing. b. The owner and dog must be listed on the current Membership List maintained by the Membership Chair. c. The dog must have earned a title in the previous calendar year (January 1 through December 31). <u>Co-Owned Dogs</u> – the above criteria apply. In addition: d. The co-owner receiving the award must be the first name listed on the dog's official ownership papers, or must be the co-owner who actually earned the title with the dog. <u>Exception:</u> this criterion does not apply to Conformation titles earned in the ring by a professional handler. e. If the first name on the dog's papers is not a member of KCTC, then no award is given regardless of who co-owns the dog. f. If there are more than two co-owners the same principles apply. Only one award will be given per dog per family at KCTC expense. Additional awards must be purchased.	4-14-14

36	REFUND POLICY – The KCTC class enrollment form states our no-refund policy. However, full or partial refunds may be given on a case-basis if approved by the Board. Guidance: the Board should not consider refunds if the student elects to miss a class or classes. But the Board should consider a refund if the instructor requests the student to withdraw from class, or due to extenuating circumstances beyond the control of the student such as an illness or injury to the student or dog.	7-17-14
37	KEYS – The President shall maintain a list of building keys. Keys are to be held by Board members, Instructors, Assistants, and cleaning personnel only. Keys shall not be lent out unless approved by the Training director or the President. Keys shall not be copied. If a key is damaged or lost, the President must authorize a new one. An Instructor or Assistant who does not teach in two consecutive session shall return his/her key to the President.	4-11-16
38	INSTRUCTOR AUTHORITY – The instructor for each class has the authority to decide on all major decisions regarding the class, including (1) class cancellations due to bad weather, (2) approval of enrollment of students who do not meet the prerequisites for their class, (3) tailoring what is taught to the level of dogs actually in each class, (4) determining if each student enrolled actually is at the right level of skill for the class, and (5) determining whether a dog is too disruptive to be in the class. If a student or dog is determined not to be suitable for the class, the instructor should request the student to drop out (and receive a refund), or switch to a more suitable class.	4-11-16
39	REIMBURSEMENTS – Receipts for reimbursements for club expenses must be submitted to the Treasurer within 30 days of the purchase in order to receive reimbursement.	5-12-16

APPENDIX A: POLICY FOR AGGRESSIVE DOGS

Revision 4-11-16

1. All students are currently required to sign a liability waiver, accepting responsibility for their dog's behavior and absolving the Keystone Canine Training Club of responsibility for any injuries to people or other dogs.
2. All members are required to sign a similar waiver, as part of the membership application or membership renewal process.
3. No aggressive dogs are allowed to participate in any Keystone sponsored or affiliated demonstrations or public events.
4. In class, if a dog shows aggressiveness toward people, the Instructor shall take the following actions:
 - Advise the student to keep the dog away from other people,
 - Alert the other students to stay away from that dog,
 - Advise the student that he or she must keep the dog under control at all times,
 - Advise the student to seek additional individual outside help, and
 - At the Instructor's discretion, advise the student to withdraw from the class and refund the class fee.
5. The Instructor shall also record the incident on an Incident Report form.
6. In class, if a dog shows aggressiveness toward another dog, the Instructor shall take the same actions as for dog-to-people aggressiveness above. Examples of dog-to-dog aggressiveness may include behavior such as lunging, barking, snapping, biting, growling, and baring of teeth.
7. If a member's dog has an incident with another member's dog, the member shall proceed as follows:
 - First incident: Advise the Instructor.
 - Second incident: Advise the Training Director, who shall talk to the member involved, evaluate the dog if appropriate, and document the findings.
 - If a member wishes to lodge a formal complaint about another member's dog, the member shall document the incident in a formal Incident Report and submit it to the Instructor or Training Director. The incident will be handled in accordance with the disciplinary section of the Bylaws.

APPENDIX B: KCTC BOARD POLICY ON E-MAIL VOTING

Revision 4-11-16

GUIDANCE FOR E-MAIL VOTING

Any member of the KCTC Board of Directors may submit a request for approval by the Board via email vote on items of an urgent nature. The use of e-mail voting will be for emergencies, or when there is a time urgency. All other items should be held for the next Board meeting.

FORMAT FOR E-MAIL VOTING

The person making the recommendation should use the words "REQUEST FOR BOARD APPROVAL" in the Subject of the e-mail. That person should also specifically say in the e-mail what the item or recommendation is and include or attach any supporting documentation. Suggested wording is "I am requesting an e-mail vote for Board approval for . . ."

RESPONSES FOR E-MAIL VOTING

All Board members shall "Reply All" to the request for an approval vote within five days of the date of the e-mail request. The response should say "Yes" or "No" (not "Sounds good to me" or words to that effect). If a Board member considers that the request warrants a discussion at the next Board meeting rather than an immediate decision, the response should say "No, defer until the next Board meeting" and the reason why. The voting process shall be exactly the same as for regular Board meetings, in accordance with the club Bylaws: (1) a quorum for a valid vote is a majority of the Board members, and (2) votes are determined by a simple majority of those voting.

DOCUMENTATION FOR E-MAIL VOTING

The person making the request shall keep track of the responses, and shall advise the Recording Secretary of the vote. The Recording Secretary shall document the vote in the next Board meeting minutes.

APPENDIX C: INSTRUCTOR PERKS

Revision 4-11-16

PERKS: After successfully meeting the apprentice requirements of Item 18, qualified instructors and assistants are then entitled to:

- Half off dues
- Discounted rates (20% off) on KCTC-sponsored in-house seminars
- Recognition at our Holiday Dinner

In addition, instructors and assistants are entitled to one free class of any type (including Specialty Classes), with one dog, for every class taught in the same session.

BUILDING USAGE: Instructors (and assistants) may use the building when classes or events or building cleanings are not scheduled, in accordance with the following: First, check the Building Usage schedule on the website to pick a time when the building is free. Then send an e-mail to info@keystonecanine.com with your name and desired time slot (date and time and room [front or back]). The time is limited to two hours per week, ending no later than one hour before any scheduled class or event. A contact person will confirm your time slot and add your name to the schedule on the website. Please note that any official club events (seminars, trials, run-thrus, etc.) supersede private building usage, even if they are scheduled after you reserve a time slot. Building usage is for the private use of instructors and assistants, not for formal lessons or classes, and non-members are not allowed to participate. Other requirements on the Building Usage website also apply (such as signing in and out).

APPENDIX D: AGILITY EQUIPMENT POLICY

Revision 4-11-16

For non-agility classes, including basic obedience classes, only the following equipment is allowed to be used:

- Open tunnels
- Tire jump set at a low height, with spotters (including handler) on both sides
- Bar jumps set at a low height
- Pause table

The full-size agility equipment will be normally be left set up in the front room all week except for when a special event is held (such as a Teacup trial, seminar, outside event rental, etc.), or for other extenuating circumstances when approved by the Training Director.

When the agility equipment is taken down, the heavy equipment should be moved to the back room, adjacent to the garage door. When special events are held in the front room, all the agility equipment should be temporarily moved out of the front room.

APPENDIX E: INSTRUCTOR EXPECTATIONS, APPOINTMENTS, AND PERFORMANCE EVALUATIONS

Revision 4-11-16

INSTRUCTOR EXPECTATIONS: Instructors and assistants are encouraged to do the following things to enhance the quality of their classes:

- Follow the syllabus (for classes with a syllabus)
- Be in charge at all times
- Keep the class moving
- Keep the handlers interested
- Give them something to strive for
- Demonstrate each command being taught
- Show interest and care for each handler
- When appropriate, tailor the instruction to the skill level of the dogs and handlers in the class
- Learn the dogs' and handlers' names as quickly as possible
- Be creative – add your humor and personality to your class
- Give equal attention to the entire class (yes, this can be hard at times!)
- Evaluate the dogs in the first two weeks, looking for aggressive or problem dogs
- Think safety – be alert to tripping hazards and ask handlers to give other dogs their needed space
- Hand out evaluation forms for basic-level classes or for new classes at the end of the session, and give the filled-out forms to the Training Director (for Basic Obedience, do this half-way through the session also)
- Conform to the agility equipment policy of APPENDIX D
- Most importantly – HAVE FUN!

THINGS INSTRUCTORS AND ASSISTANTS SHOULD NOT DO:

- Be negative
- Sit for a lengthy time while instructing
- Let students stand around talking or stand around on one item for a long time (assistants can work one-on-one while you keep it moving)
- Talk about yourself or your dog too much (they are here to learn, not to hear you brag)
- Avoid tough dogs or difficult handlers
- Leave your dog not confined or crated when not actively performing demonstrations

INSTRUCTOR APPOINTMENTS

Instructors and assistants shall be appointed or approved by the Training Director, and shall serve at the will of the Training Director. The Training Director may dismiss any instructor or assistant at any time for cause, subject to the approval of the Board.

INSTRUCTOR EVALUATIONS

1. The Training Director (TD) should review the class evaluation forms filled out by the students. The TD may appoint one or more experienced instructors to assist in this effort.
2. Based on the class evaluation forms filled out by the students and any other input received for a specific class or instructor, the TD shall provide any appropriate feedback and suggestions to the instructors and assistants. The TD should also share any “best practices” with other instructors and assistants.
3. In the event that the TD considers the instructor’s performance is unsatisfactory, the TD shall provide the instructor with a written performance evaluation or by email, citing the positives and the negatives, and list the specific things that require improvement.
4. After receipt of the report, the instructor must agree to correct the deficiencies and be re-evaluated by the TD at a mutually agreed-upon upcoming class.
5. If the deficiencies are not corrected, the TD shall inform the instructor that he or she may not teach any classes after the current session.

APPENDIX F

FACEBOOK AND TWITTER POLICIES

Revision 4-11-16

NOTE: THESE POLICIES APPLY TO THE OFFICIAL KEYSTONE CANINE TRAINING CLUB GROUP, THE OFFICIAL KEYSTONE CANINE TRAINING CLUB FACEBOOK PAGE AND THE OFFICIAL KEYSTONE CANINE TRAINING CLUB TWITTER ACCOUNT.

1. The Official Keystone Canine Training Club Facebook Group.

- a. This group was created for dog club members to network, ask questions and get to know one another. This is a private group; members can only be added by administrators. Members of this group should only include club members.
- b. Members of this group may: post questions about the club's classes and events; ask questions about groomers and dog stores in the area; ask 'getting to know you'-type questions, and ask questions about general dog issues and events. We always love seeing interaction between group members; feel free to get to know everyone and ask questions about everything dog!

2. The Official Keystone Canine Training Club Facebook Page.

- a. This group was created for dog club members and those interested in KCTC posts and updates on the latest dog club news, ask questions, and learn.
- b. Members of this page may: comment on/like statuses, photos and event pages for the dog club. This page is meant to be informative AND fun.

3. The Official Keystone Canine Training Club Twitter Account.

- a. This account was created for dog club members to receive updates on the latest dog club news, ask questions, and learn.
 - i. This is an open account. Followers are added as they follow the account. Followers of this account should only include club members and those interested in becoming club members.
 - ii. Followers of this account may: reply to tweets; favorite tweets; retweet tweets.
 - iii. This account is meant to be informative AND fun.

4. Rules and Regulations

- a. Members of the Facebook group, Facebook page, and Twitter account may NOT: post/comment or tweet about personal issues pertaining to outside problems; problems between club members; problems between members and the club; vent; ask people to promote/work with their private businesses; or request money for philanthropies/events.

- b. Any personal problems should be resolved between individuals outside of the club. Problems between club members should be resolved between themselves, and/or with a member of the club's Board or Directors acting as a neutral third party. Problems between members and the club should be resolved between the individual(s) and the Board of Directors. Venting should be reserved for the individual's personal Facebook page. Promotion of someone's own private business is not appropriate for posting. Promotion of someone's philanthropies/events is also not appropriate for posting.

ANYONE FOUND IN VIOLATION OF THESE POLICIES WILL BE REMOVED AND BANNED FROM THE GROUP, PAGE OR ACCOUNT IMMEDIATELY, NO QUESTIONS ASKED.

APPENDIX G: SESSION PLANNING TIMELINE

Revision 4-11-16

WHEN	ACTION	WHO
6 weeks before session begins	Post session start date and enrollment start date on website	Website editor
4.5 weeks before session begins	Send Webmaster and Roster Coordinator the upcoming session schedule	Training Director
3.5 weeks before session begins	Send Webmaster the enrollment forms and enrollment instructions	Roster Coordinator
17 days before session begins	Post schedule and enrollment instructions on the website	Webmaster
15 days before session begins	Enrollments open	n/a
5 days before session begins	Enrollments close	n/a